

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

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Problem Statement:

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

User story

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimizing manual intervention.

Project Objective:

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to:

1. Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
2. Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
3. Improve resource utilization within the IT department by optimizing task allocation.
Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.
4. Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

TASK INITIATION

Milestone 1 : Flow

Activity 1:

Create a Flow to Create Catalog task to update the short description after Approval the service Request and it will be Assignment group to Hardware.

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for Flow Designer
3. Click on Flow Designer under Process Automation.
4. After opening Flow Designer Click on new and select Flow.
5. Under Flow properties Give Flow Name as “Standard laptop task”.
6. Application should be Global.
7. Select Run user as “System user” from that choice.
8. Click on Submit.

Flow

FAVORITES

No Results

ALL RESULTS

✓ Docker Webhook Answer Subf...

Docker Webhook Answer Subf...

Webhook Answer Subflow

✓ Process Automation Flow & Action Designer

Flow Designer ↗



✓ Flow Administration

servicenow Flow Designer

Flows Subflows Actions Executions Connections Help

New ▾

Flow
Subflow
Action
Data Stream

Search Updated ▾ Search

All

	Name	Internal name	Application	Status	Active	Updated ▾	Updated by
☐	Standard Laptop task	standard_laptop_task	Global	Published	true	2024-04-16 23:33:53	admin
☐	Email Sending For P1	email_sending_for_p1	Global	Published	false	2024-04-16 04:22:31	admin
☐	Daily Task Reminder	daily_task_reminder	Global	Draft	false	2024-04-16 00:08:03	admin

Flow properties

* Flow name

Description

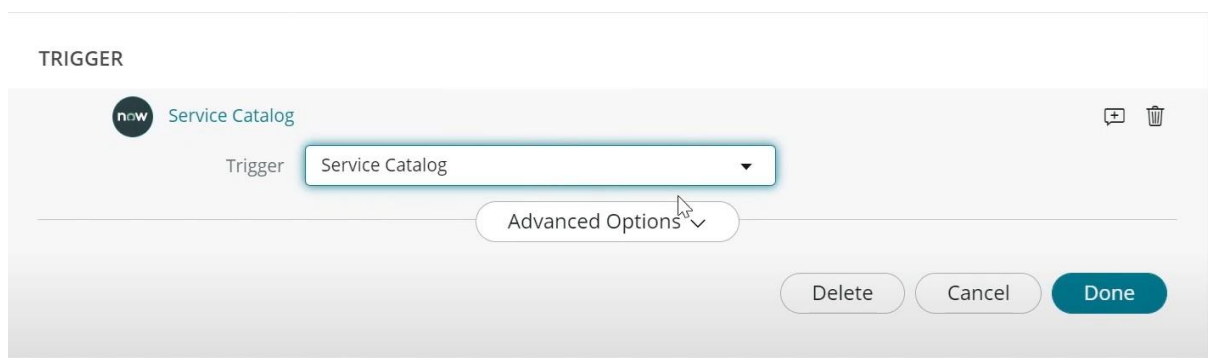
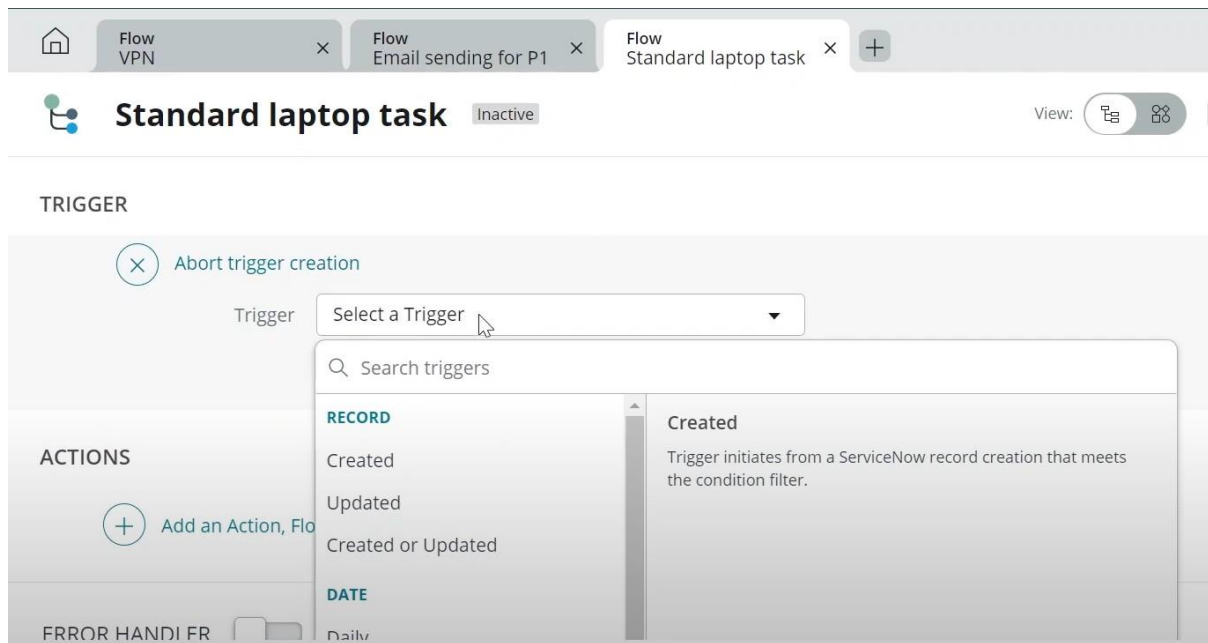
Application

Protection

Run As

Cancel Submit

1. Click on Add a trigger
2. Select the trigger in that Search for “Service Catalog” and select that.
3. After that click on Done.



1. Now under Actions.
2. Click on Add an action.
3. Select action in that search for "Create Catalog Task" and select that.
4. Mention these in that action
5. Action as Create Catalog Task
6. Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request item.
7. Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.
8. Mention the short description as "Laptop need to Configured".
9. Click on add field value
10. Select description field and value as "Laptop need to Configured".
11. Select Assignment group field and value as "Hardware".
12. Select Approval field and value as "Approved".
13. Leave the remaining as default and click on Done.
14. Click on save the Flow.
15. And Click on Activate again click on Activate.

Standard Laptop task

Active

ERROR HAND

If an error occurs

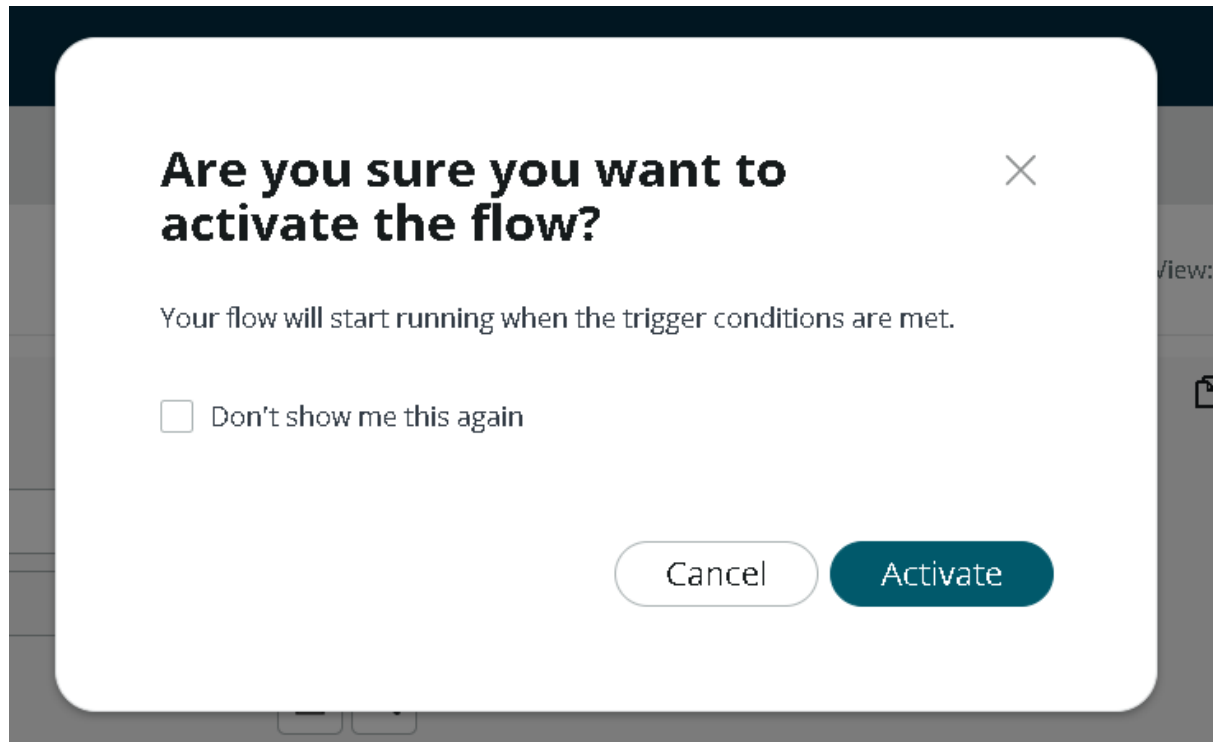
Standard Laptop task Active

View: 🔍 ⚙️ | Test De

1 new Create Catalog Task ⓘ

Action	Create Catalog Task ▾		
Table Name	Catalog Task [sc_task] ▾	📄 🗑️	
* Requested Item [Requested Item]	Trigger - ... ▶ Requested Item ... ✕	📄 🗑️	
Short Description	Laptop needs to Configured	📄 🗑️	
Fields	Description ✕ ▾ Assignment group ✕ ▾ Approval ✕ ▾ + Add field value	Laptop needs to Configured Hardware ✕ ▾ Approved ▾	📄 🗑️ ⊖ 📄 🗑️ ⊖ 📄 🗑️ ⊖
Wait	☒	📄 🗑️	

Template Catalog



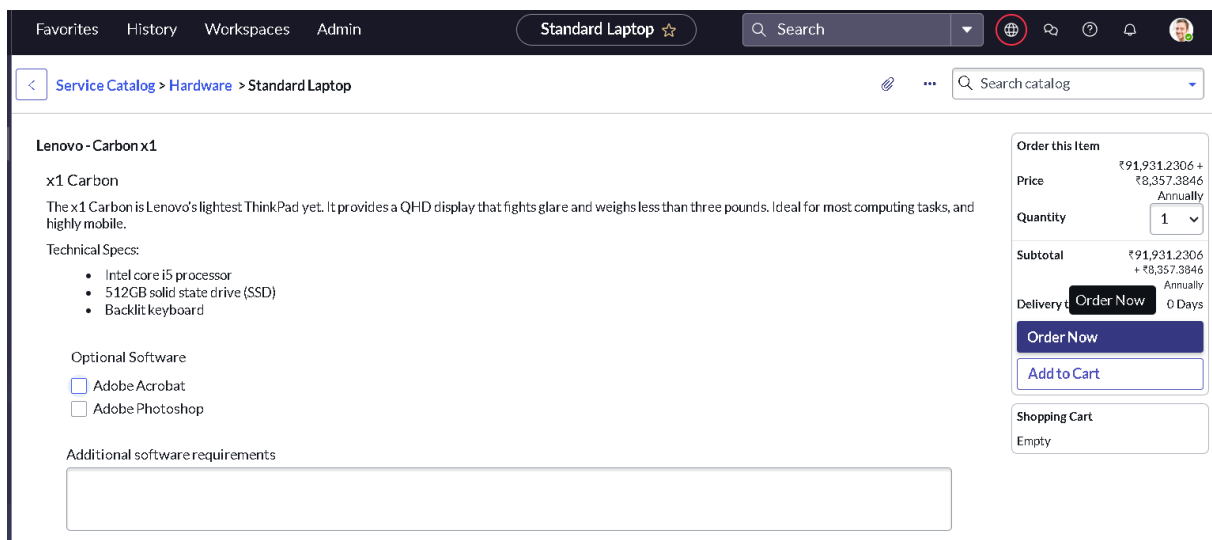
Milestone 2 : Flow assignment

Activity 1 :

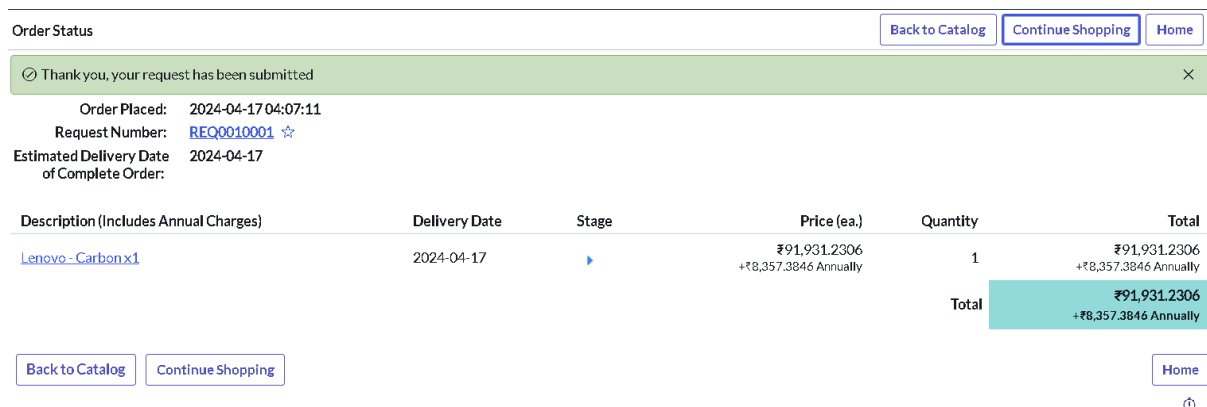
Flow Assignment to Standard laptop service Catalog.

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on all search for Maintain Items.
3. Select Maintain Items.
4. Under the name field search for Standard Laptop Select that record.
5. Under that record select Process engine.
6. Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
7. Add the flow that was created with the name “Standard Laptop Task”.
8. Click on the menu to save the record.

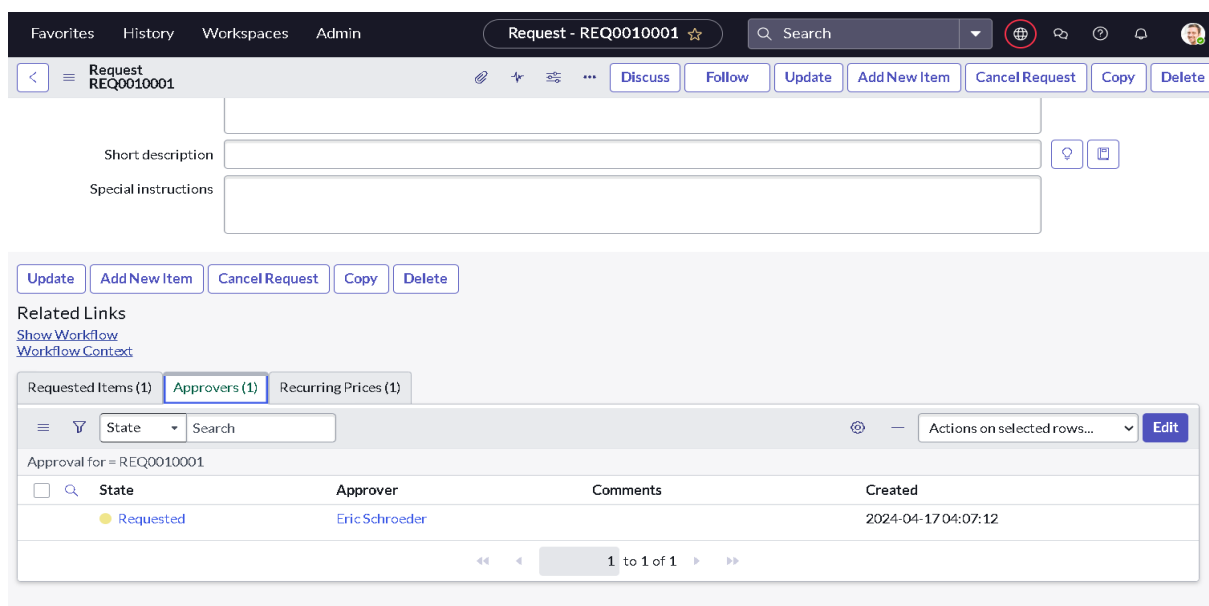
Name	Short description	Active	Roles	Catalogs	Category	Price	Type	Updated
standard	Search	Search	Search	Search	Search	Search	!=Package	Search
Standard Laptop	Lenovo - Carbonx1	true		Service Catalog	Hardware	\$1,100.00	Item	2024-04-16 04:14:53
Standard 27" Monitor	Size - 27", Resolution - 1920x1080, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$0.00	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
Standard 22" Monitor	Full HD, IPS Panel with VGA, HDMI, DVI, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$200.00	Item	2016-03-08 16:49:50
Standard 24" Monitor	TUV-certified Monitor Has Flicker-free S...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$292.28	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33



1. Now we will see the Order status
2. In that click on the Request Number



1. It will open the Requested number record.
2. Scroll down Click on the Approvers Section.



1. Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.

[Update](#) [Add New Item](#) [Cancel Request](#) [Copy](#) [Delete](#)

Related Links

[Show Workflow](#)
[Workflow Context](#)

Requested Items (1)	Prices (1)
≡ 🔍 State Approval for = REQO ☐ 🔍 State	ⓘ — Actions on selected rows... ▾ Edit
● Requested Eric Schroeder	Approver Comments Created 2024-04-17 04:07:12

1 to 1 of 1

2. Then click on the Requested item Section
3. Open that Requested Item record

Requested Item - RITM0010001

Activities: 1

System Administrator

Field changes • 2024-04-17 04:07:10

- Impact**: 3 - Low
- Opened by**: System Administrator
- Priority**: 4 - Low
- State**: Open

[Update](#) [Delete](#)

Related Links

[Flow Context](#)

Catalog Tasks (1) | Approvers | Group approvals

Number	Search	Actions on selected rows...	New			
Request item = RITM0010001						
Number	Assignment group	Assigned to	Short description	Actual start	Actual end	Order
SCTASK0010001	Hardware	(empty)	Laptop needs to Configured	2024-04-17 04:11:40	(empty)	

1 to 1 of 1

4. Scroll down to the “ Catalog tasks ” Section
5. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.

The screenshot displays a ServiceNow Catalog Task record for SCTASK0010001. The interface includes a top navigation bar with buttons for Discuss, Follow, Update, Close Task, and Delete. The record details are organized into two columns. The left column contains fields for Number (SCTASK0010001), Assigned to (with a search icon), Configuration item (with a search icon), Active (checked), Short description (Laptop needs to Configured), Description (Laptop needs to Configured), and Worknotes (Worknotes). The right column contains fields for Approval (Approved), Priority (4 - Low), State (Open), Request item (RITM0010001), and Requested for (System Administrator). A Post button is located at the bottom right of the form. The bottom of the screen shows an Activities section with a filter icon.

Number	SCTASK0010001	Approval	Approved
Assigned to		Priority	4 - Low
Configuration item		State	Open
Active	☒	Request item	RITM0010001
Short description	Laptop needs to Configured	Requested for	System Administrator
Description	Laptop needs to Configured		
Worknotes	Worknotes		

Conclusion

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow’s Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.